American Sovereign Bullion

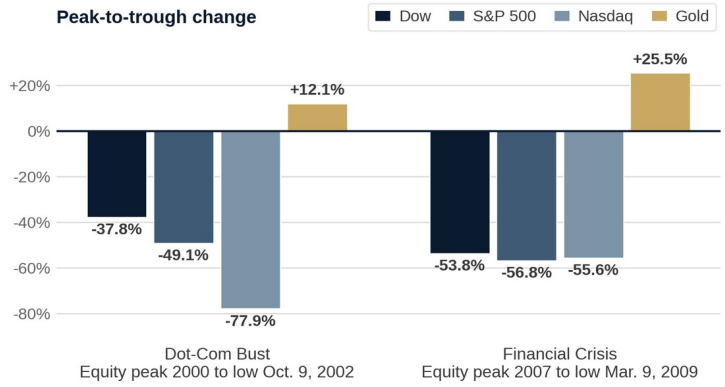
AUGUST 17, 2026

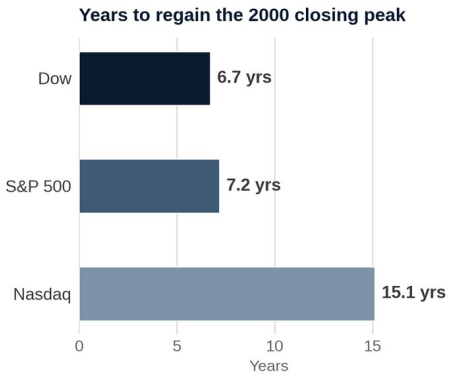
THREE INDEXES AND GOLD. TWO CRASHES. TWENTY-SIX YEARS.

What the Market Did, and How Long It Took to Recover

The Dow Jones Industrial Average, the S&P 500, the Nasdaq Composite, and gold at the peak and trough of the last two bear markets, and at the most recent close.

INDEX	DOT-COM PEAK	LOW Oct. 9, 2002	CRISIS PEAK	LOW Mar. 9, 2009	CLOSE Aug. 14, 2026
Dow	11,722.98 Jan. 14, 2000	7,286.27	14,164.53 Oct. 9, 2007	6,547.05	53,732.41
S&P 500	1,527.46 Mar. 24, 2000	776.76	1,565.15 Oct. 9, 2007	676.53	7,785.76
Nasdaq	5,048.62 Mar. 10, 2000	1,114.11	2,859.12 Oct. 31, 2007	1,268.64	26,729.16
Gold	$284.85 Mar. 24, 2000	$319.35	$736.00 Oct. 9, 2007	$923.75	$4,437.30





Sources: S&P Dow Jones Indices and Nasdaq closing values; LBMA Gold Price PM fix. Gold does not appear in the right panel because it did not decline over these two windows.

THE DECLINE IS NOT THE RISK. THE RECOVERY TIME IS.

Both crashes ended. Every index recovered, and every index now sits far above where it started. On August 14, 2026 the Dow closed at 4.6 times its January 2000 peak, the S&P 500 at 5.1 times, and the Nasdaq at 5.3 times. Gold, measured from the same March 2000 reference, closed at 15.6 times its level then. Anyone who held on and had the years to spare came out ahead.

The years are the variable. An investor who turned 55 in 2000 was 61 when the Dow regained its old high, 62 when the S&P 500 regained its own, and 70 when the Nasdaq finally regained its own on April 23, 2015. An investor who was 68 in October 2007 was 73 before the Dow and the S&P 500 got back to even. The decline is what makes the news. The calendar is what determines whether a household ever sees the recovery.

Read the gold bars narrowly. They show what gold did across two windows whose start and end dates were set by equity peaks and equity troughs, not by anything about gold. Gold has had its own long declines, including a multi-decade drawdown following its January 1980 peak and a multi-year decline from 2011 into 2015. Nothing on this page says that gold rises when stocks fall. It says these assets did not move together across these two windows.

Notes. Index figures are closing values of the price indexes and exclude reinvested dividends; total return over the same periods was higher. Gold figures are the LBMA Gold Price PM fix, except the August 14, 2026 figure, which is a spot quote for the same session. Gold is shown against the S&P 500 peak dates because the three indexes peaked on three different days. The Dow and the S&P 500 peaked on October 9, 2007; the Nasdaq peaked on October 31, 2007.

Recovery dates. Dow, October 3, 2006 (11,727.34). S&P 500, May 30, 2007 (1,530.23). Nasdaq, April 23, 2015 (5,056.06). Sources: S&P Dow Jones Indices; Nasdaq; London Bullion Market Association; and contemporaneous reporting by the Associated Press, Reuters, CNBC, and NPR.